Alternative Supplier Evaluation Policy

SYN-POL-03 | Version 1.0 | Status: Synthetic MVP guidance

Synthetic operational knowledge created for the Option C Logistics project demonstration. This document is not a real company policy and must not be used for live operational decisions.

Purpose	Define how synthetic or approved supplier data should be filtered and ranked for alternative sourcing.
Applies to	Supply-chain disruption agent demonstration, operations review, and RAG retrieval testing.
Decision authority	Human operations reviewer. The AI system provides evidence and recommendations only.
Evidence rule	Use only observed tool evidence, model output, and retrieved guidance. Do not invent operational facts.

1. When to assess alternatives

- A MEDIUM or HIGH risk shipment may affect a critical delivery window.
- The current source is unavailable, capacity constrained, or operationally high risk.
- Inventory coverage is insufficient for the expected disruption period.
- A human operations reviewer requests an alternative sourcing assessment.

2. Minimum supplier evidence

- Supplier identifier and explicit data-source label.
- Product category or capability match.
- Destination or service-region compatibility.
- Estimated lead time, on-time rate, cancellation rate, and quality issue rate where available.
- Capacity or availability status and any quantity constraint.
- Risk score or risk level calculated by documented rules.

3. Ranking approach

1. Filter out suppliers that cannot serve the required category or destination.
2. Exclude unavailable or capacity-constrained candidates unless no viable alternative exists.
3. Rank viable candidates by operational risk, delivery-window fit, service reliability, and then cost.
4. Return multiple candidates, not only a single unsupported recommendation.

5 Explain why the recommended supplier ranks above the alternatives.

4. Synthetic-data rule

Every demonstration-only supplier record must use data_source = SYNTHETIC_MVP. The briefing must never present a synthetic supplier as a real contracted supplier.

5. Human approval

Supplier substitution is a decision-support recommendation only. Commercial, compliance, quality, and contractual approval remain human responsibilities.

6. Suggested output

Recommended supplier	Supplier ID, risk level, lead time, and reason for selection.
Alternatives	At least one additional viable candidate where available.
Limitations	Missing price, availability, quality, geography, or contract evidence.
Data source	APPROVED_OPERATIONAL or SYNTHETIC_MVP.